

Enthusiasm does not come from "nowhere," but once it arrives it seems absolutely to take hold of everything else.

For many years I did most of my writing at night. Naturally enough, I would grow tired after a few hours. One night I was engaged on a piece of work which filled me with enthusiasm. After a while I looked out the window, across Madison Square in New York City, and noticed the Metropolitan Life Insurance Company's tower. I saw a strange, silvery-gray reflection on the tower. The moon, I thought, but I had never seen the moon reflected in such an odd color. It was not a reflection of the moon, but of the sun! My enthusiasm had kept me working all night without fatigue. Moreover, the same enthusiasm kept me working all through the day and the next night as well, stopping only for some light food. After that, with my task completed, I felt normally tired.

Enthusiasm is a vital force that energizes all the forces of your mind and body. Make enthusiasm part of any auto-suggestion process; part of *you*.

Help other minds to vibrate in harmony with your own. We have spoken of "mind radio." I speak now of something which may be the same, or, if not, is surely akin. It is the contagiousness of enthusiasm; its almost magical power to "sell" ideas to others.

Anyone who has spoken to an audience has sensed, at times, that he is "getting over." For a few magical moments his enthusiasm catches every other mind in that room or hall, and what he says in those moments stays with his audience; they carry it home with them.

Enthusiasm, however carefully handled, is the indispensable tool of any salesman. It brings the two minds—the seller's mind and the buyer's mind—into *rapport*, or harmony. It allows the salesman to transmit to the buyer a feeling of need for the product, an appreciation of its worth, a willingness to part with money for the sake of making his life more full and happy—a service in which he sees what the product will do for him.

What you say is important, of course. No mere combination of words, however, can do the work it is supposed to do unless those words carry the spirit of conviction, belief, faith, *enthusiasm* which conveys all these.

In order to make this point clear, let us look at what happens when the opposite effect comes into play. Enthusiasm is perfectly positive; what happens when a negative thought is conveyed?